COURSE SLIDES

AI Agents with Gemini Spark (C1259)

Course Code: C1259

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

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About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General Trainer template —
to be completed by the trainer

NAME

TITLE / DESIGNATION

QUALIFICATIONS

AREAS OF EXPERTISE

TRAINING & INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

CONTACT

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YOUR TRAINER

About the Trainer



Dr. Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer
Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

ROLE
Principal Trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

CERTIFICATION
Industry certified in the subject area of this course.

DELIVERS
Professional short courses for Tertiary Infotech Academy.

FOUNDER
Founder and lead instructor at Tertiary Infotech / Tertiary Courses.

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ICE-BREAKER

Let's Know Each Other

1. Your name and organisation / role.

2. Your experience with this subject (if any).

3. What you want to be able to do after this course.

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HOUSEKEEPING

Ground Rules

1. Set your mobile phone to silent mode.
2. Participate actively — no question is too small.
3. Mutual respect: agree to disagree.
4. One conversation at a time.
5. Be punctual; return from breaks on time.
6. Learn by doing — try every hands-on lab.

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COURSE PORTAL

Download Course Material

1. Sign in at the LMS-TMS portal
2. Open this course from your dashboard
3. Go to the Courseware tab
4. Download the Slides (PPT/PDF), Learner Guide and Lesson Plan
5. Keep them open alongside the labs as you work

Portal: https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com

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SCHEDULE

Lesson Plan — 2 Days, 8 hours/day

Day 1

- Day 1 — Getting started with Gemini Spark and automating your daily work with tasks
  - Topic 1: Getting Started with AI Agents and Gemini Spark (Labs 1–3)
  - Topic 2: Automating Work with Gemini Spark Tasks (Labs 4–6)

Day 2

- Day 2 — Reusable skills and schedules, then advanced real-world agentic workflows
  - Topic 3: Building Reusable Skills and Schedules (Labs 7–9)
  - Topic 4: Advanced Agentic Workflows and Real-World Automation (Labs 10–12)
- Daily timing
  - 9:30am–6:30pm · 1-hour lunch · tea breaks within training time

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WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Learning Outcomes

1

Understand agents

Explain what autonomous AI agents are and how Gemini Spark's background agents, approvals and controls work.

2

Connect & instruct

Connect Gemini Spark to Google Workspace and write clear, effective instructions that an agent can act on.

3

Automate with tasks

Create one-off agent tasks to research, organise, summarise email and draft content across Docs, Sheets and Slides.

4

Review & approve

Review, approve and refine agent actions so automated work stays accurate and under your control.

5

Skills & schedules

Build custom reusable skills and design schedules and conditional triggers that run automatically.

6

Chain & personalise

Chain multi-step workflows across several Workspace apps and personalise your agent's behaviour and style.

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WHAT YOU'LL ACHIEVE

Learning Outcomes (cont.)

7

Real-world automation

Automate real-world workflows — lead management, expenses and planning — with sound permission and privacy guardrails.

8

Monitor & scale

Monitor, improve and scale your AI agents responsibly.

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LEARNING APPROACH

How You'll Learn

1. Trainer demonstrates the concept
2. You build it yourself in the hands-on lab
3. Verify with the lab's 'Test it' step
4. Discuss and troubleshoot together
5. Recap against the learning outcomes

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CORE CONCEPTS

Course Fundamentals

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OVERVIEW

What an AI Agent Really Is

1. From chatbot to agent — a chatbot replies; an agent takes actions across your apps to reach a goal.
2. You stay in charge — the agent proposes and prepares; you approve before anything leaves your account.
3. It works where you work — Spark acts inside Gmail, Calendar, Drive, Docs, Sheets and Slides.
4. Everything is logged — an activity trail lets you inspect, trust and undo what the agent did.

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The Spark Automation Loop

1

Instruct

State the goal, the inputs, the output and the limits in plain language.

2

Run

Spark plans the steps and works through them as a background agent.

3

Review

You inspect what it produced against the result you expected.

4

Approve

Nothing is sent, shared or changed until you give the go-ahead.

5

Refine

Adjust the instruction and save the good ones as reusable skills.

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THE DESIGN RULE

An agent is only as good as the instruction and the guardrails you give it.

This course is hands-on: you will instruct, run, review and refine real agents on your own Workspace, then save the ones that work as reusable skills and schedules.

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COURSE ROADMAP

What You'll Build

A connected agent

- Spark linked to Gmail, Calendar and Drive
- A tested first task
- A clear instruction template

A task toolkit

- Research and organisation tasks
- Inbox summary and reply drafting
- Docs, Sheets and Slides generation

Reusable automation

- A named Ghostwriter skill
- A scheduled daily digest
- A conditional trigger and a chained workflow

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THE LEARNING ARC

How Every Lab Works

1. The trainer demonstrates the agent technique on a shared example.
2. You build it yourself in Gemini Spark on your own Workspace (or the supplied sample data).
3. You verify the result against the lab's explicit 'Test it' check.
4. You review the agent's actions in the activity log and refine the instruction.
5. You keep the working skill or schedule — it becomes part of your automation toolkit.

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01

TOPIC 01

Getting Started with AI Agents and Gemini Spark

What autonomous agents are · How Spark works · Connecting Workspace · Instructing your agent

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Key Concepts — Getting Started with AI Agents and Gemini Spark

1. Autonomous AI agents — an agent doesn't just answer; it plans and carries out multi-step tasks toward a goal you set.
2. Gemini Spark — Google's agentic layer that works across your Workspace apps to get real tasks done for you.
3. Background agents — Spark can work through a task on your behalf while you get on with something else.
4. Approvals and control — Spark pauses for your approval before it sends, shares or changes anything that matters.
5. Connecting Workspace — Spark acts through Gmail, Calendar and Drive using your existing Google account permissions.
6. The activity log — every action an agent takes is recorded so you can see, trust and undo what it did.

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Key Concepts — Getting Started with AI Agents and Gemini Spark (cont.)

7

Effective instructing — a good instruction states the goal, the inputs, the output and the limits in plain language.

8

Prompt vs instruction — a chat prompt asks for text; an agent instruction asks for an outcome you can check.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Getting Started with AI Agents and Gemini Spark

Lab 1

- Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

Lab 2

- See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

Lab 3

- Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

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TOPIC 01 · HANDS-ON

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

LAB 1

This lab gets your agent working. You confirm Spark is available on your account, connect it to the Workspace apps it will act through, and run one small, fully supervised task so you can see the instruct-run-review-approve loop end to end before you rely on it. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A working Gemini Spark connected to Gmail, Calendar and Drive, plus one completed, reviewed first task.

Tools: Gemini Spark, Google account, Gmail, Calendar, Drive, approvals

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LAB 1

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Open gemini.google.com in Chrome or Edge and sign in with the Google account you will use for the course.

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LAB 1

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Find Gemini Spark (the agent/automation area). If you cannot see it, tell the trainer — access is confirmed at the start of Day 1.

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LAB 1

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Open the connections/permissions panel and confirm Spark can access Gmail, Calendar and Drive. Grant access to those three only, for now.

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LAB 1

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Read the approval setting: confirm Spark will ask before it sends email, shares files or edits anything. Leave approvals ON.

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LAB 1

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Run a first, safe task: ask the agent to list your three next calendar events. This only reads data, so it is a gentle first run.

```
$ List my next 3 calendar events with date, time and title. Do not change anything.
```


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LAB 1

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Watch how the agent works: it states a plan, carries it out, and shows you the result. Read the result before doing anything else.

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LAB 1

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Ask one follow-up so you see the agent hold context: have it note which of those events has no agenda yet.

```
$ Of those 3 events, tell me which have no agenda in the description.
```


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LAB 1

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Confirm nothing was changed in your calendar — this was a read-only task. You have now seen the full loop safely.

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LAB 1 · VERIFY

Set Up Gemini Spark and Connect Your Google Workspace

Test it

Gemini Spark is connected to Gmail, Calendar and Drive, approvals are ON, and the agent has returned a correct list of your next three events without changing anything.

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TOPIC 01 · HANDS-ON

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

LAB 2

Now you learn to trust the agent by watching it closely. You give Spark a task that PROPOSES a change, stop at the approval gate, then approve it — and find the whole thing again in the activity log, where you can review and undo. This is the control model the rest of the course depends on. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A drafted (not sent) email held at the approval gate, plus a reviewed activity-log entry you can undo.

Tools: Background agents, approval gate, activity log, undo, Gmail draft

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LAB 2

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Give the agent a task that prepares a change but must stop for approval: draft (do not send) a short reply to your most recent email.

```
$ Draft a brief, friendly reply to my most recent email. Save it as a draft. Do not send it.
```


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LAB 2

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

STEP 2 OF 8

2

While it works, start a second, unrelated read task so you can see a background agent working alongside you.

```
$ Separately, summarise the subjects of my last 5 emails in one line each.
```


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LAB 2

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Return to the reply task and find the approval gate: the agent has prepared a draft and is waiting for your decision. Read the draft.

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LAB 2

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Do NOT approve sending. Choose the option that keeps it as a draft only, then open Gmail and confirm the draft exists and was not sent.

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LAB 2

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Open the activity log (the agent's history of actions). Find the entry for the draft you just created.

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LAB 2

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Open that log entry and read exactly what the agent did, which app it touched, and when. This is your audit trail.

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LAB 2

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Practise undo: use the log to undo or discard the draft. Confirm in Gmail that the draft is gone.

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LAB 2

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Write one sentence in your own notes: what will you always check in the activity log before you approve an action?

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LAB 2 · VERIFY

See How Spark Works — Background Agents, Approvals and the Activity Log

Test it

You created a reply as a draft only (never sent), located and read its entry in the activity log, and successfully undid it — confirming the draft no longer exists in Gmail.

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TOPIC 01 · HANDS-ON

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

LAB 3

An agent is only as good as its instruction. You compare a vague instruction with a specific one, see the difference in the result, then distil what worked into a reusable template — Goal, Inputs, Output, Limits — that you will use for every task from here on. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A four-part instruction template and one strong, tested instruction saved for reuse.

Tools: Instruction design, goal/inputs/output/limits, prompt comparison, refinement

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LAB 3

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Run a deliberately vague instruction and note how generic or off-target the result is.

```
$ Sort out my inbox.
```


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LAB 3

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Now run a specific instruction for the same intent and compare the result — it should be sharper and more useful.

```
$ Group my unread emails from the last 2 days into: needs a reply, for information, and can archive. List subjects under each.
```


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LAB 3

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Write down the four parts that made the second instruction work: the Goal, the Inputs it uses, the Output you want, and the Limits.

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LAB 3

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Capture your reusable template in your notes so every future task follows it.

```
$ GOAL: <what outcome> | INPUTS: <which emails/files/dates> | OUTPUT: <format & where> | LIMITS: <what NOT to do, e.g. do not send>
```


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LAB 3

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Add limits that keep you safe by default: never send, share or delete without approval; ignore anything marked confidential.

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LAB 3

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Rewrite one everyday task of your own using the template — for example a weekly status summary — and run it.

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LAB 3

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Refine once: change one part of the instruction (Output or Limits) and re-run to see how the result changes. Keep the better version.

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LAB 3

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Save your best instruction where you can find it again — you will turn it into a reusable skill in Topic 3.

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LAB 3 · VERIFY

Instruct Your Agent — Effective Prompting and a Reusable Instruction Template

Test it

You can show two results for the same intent (vague vs specific), a written four-part instruction template, and one refined instruction that produced the output you specified in the format you asked for.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Getting Started with AI Agents and Gemini Spark

1. You can now: Access Gemini Spark, connect it to Gmail, Calendar and Drive, and run a first supervised task.

2. You can now: Run a background task, use the approval gate, and inspect and undo actions from the activity log.

3. You can now: Write clear agent instructions and capture a reusable instruction template that gets good results first time.

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02

TOPIC 02

Automating Work with Gemini Spark Tasks

One-off tasks · Email summaries and drafting · Docs, Sheets and Slides · Reviewing and refining

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COURSE COVERAGE 30%

Key Concepts — Automating Work with Gemini Spark Tasks

1. One-off tasks — a single instruction Spark runs once, ideal for research, clean-up and organising work.
2. Research tasks — ask the agent to gather, compare and summarise information into a structured result you can reuse.
3. Inbox summaries — Spark reads a busy inbox and hands you a short, prioritised digest of what needs attention.
4. Email drafting — the agent drafts replies in your voice and leaves them for you to review before anything is sent.
5. Working with Docs — generate outlines, first drafts and formatted documents straight into Google Docs.
6. Working with Sheets — turn messy inputs into a clean, structured spreadsheet the agent fills for you.

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Key Concepts — Automating Work with Gemini Spark Tasks (cont.)

7 Working with Slides — draft a presentation deck from a brief or a document, ready for you to polish.

8 Reviewing and refining — you inspect each result, approve the good, and refine the instruction until it is right.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Automating Work with Gemini Spark Tasks

Lab 4

- Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

Lab 5

- Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

Lab 6

- Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

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TOPIC 02 · HANDS-ON

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

LAB 4

One-off tasks are the workhorse of Spark: a single instruction the agent runs once. You run a research task that returns a structured, reusable result, then an organisation task that tidies your inbox and Drive — reviewing both before you accept them. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A structured research brief in a Doc, plus a tidied inbox and a proposed Drive folder structure.

Tools: One-off tasks, research, summarisation, Gmail labels, Drive organisation, Docs

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LAB 4

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Run a research task with a clear output format. Ask for a short, structured brief you can reuse, not a wall of text.

```
$ Research 3 quick ways a small studio can use AI agents to save admin time. Give me a Doc with a heading and 3 bullet points each. Cite sources.
```


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LAB 4

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Open the resulting Doc and check it against what you asked for: heading, three items, three bullets each, sources. Refine if a part is missing.

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LAB 4

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Now an organisation task on email. Ask the agent to propose labels for your unread mail — proposing, not applying, so you review first.

```
$ Suggest a label for each of my unread emails from this week: Client, Supplier, Internal or Newsletter. List them; do not apply labels yet.
```


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LAB 4

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Review the proposed labels. Approve only the ones you agree with, then let the agent apply just those.

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LAB 4

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Run a Drive organisation task. Ask the agent to propose a folder structure for a set of files, without moving anything yet.

```
$ Look at the files in my 'Brightwave/Incoming' folder and propose a folder structure to organise them. Show the plan; do not move files yet.
```


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LAB 4

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Read the proposed structure. Adjust one folder name, then approve the move for a small, safe subset of files.

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LAB 4

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Confirm in Drive that only the files you approved were moved, and nothing else changed.

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LAB 4

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Note which of these two tasks you would want to run regularly — you will schedule one in Topic 3.

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LAB 4 · VERIFY

Create One-Off Tasks for Research and Organisation

Test it

You have a research Doc in exactly the format you specified, labels applied only to the emails you approved, and a small set of files moved into an approved folder structure with nothing else changed.

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TOPIC 02 · HANDS-ON

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

LAB 5

This is the automation most people feel first: a clear inbox. The agent reads your mail and hands you a prioritised digest, then drafts replies to the messages that need one — in your voice, left as drafts for you to review and send. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A prioritised inbox digest and two review-ready reply drafts in your voice.

Tools: Inbox summary, prioritisation, reply drafting, tone matching, Gmail drafts, approvals

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LAB 5

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Ask for a prioritised inbox summary with a clear structure so you can act on it in seconds.

```
$ Summarise my unread emails from today. Group as: Urgent, Needs a reply, FYI. One line each with sender and the ask.
```


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LAB 5

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Read the digest and sanity-check it: is anything urgent mis-sorted? If so, refine the instruction (e.g. define what 'urgent' means to you).

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LAB 5

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Give the agent your tone so drafts sound like you. Describe it in a sentence and give one short example of how you sign off.

```
$ My email tone: warm, brief, plain English. I open with 'Hi <name>,' and sign off 'Thanks, <YOUR NAME>'.
```


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LAB 5

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Ask the agent to draft replies to the two emails from your 'Needs a reply' group — as drafts only, not sent.

```
$ Draft replies to the 2 'Needs a reply' emails using my tone. Save as drafts. Do not send.
```


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LAB 5

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Open each draft in Gmail. Check the facts, the tone and that it answered the actual ask. Edit anything that is not quite right.

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LAB 5

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Approve and send only the drafts you are happy with; leave the rest as drafts to finish later.

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LAB 5

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Refine your tone instruction once based on what you had to edit, so the next drafts need less correction.

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LAB 5

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Confirm in Gmail Sent that only the replies you approved were sent, and the digest matched your real inbox.

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LAB 5 · VERIFY

Automate Email — Inbox Summaries and Reply Drafting

Test it

You produced a prioritised digest that matches your inbox, two drafts written in your voice, and sent only the ones you personally reviewed and approved.

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TOPIC 02 · HANDS-ON

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

LAB 6

Spark can produce first drafts across the Workspace apps so you start from 80%, not a blank page. You generate a document, turn scattered notes into a structured spreadsheet, and draft a short deck — then apply the review-and-refine discipline to each so the output is actually usable. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A drafted Doc, a populated Sheet and a short Slides deck, each reviewed and refined once.

Tools: Google Docs, Google Sheets, Google Slides, content generation, structured extraction, review and refine

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LAB 6

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Generate a Doc from a brief. Be specific about structure and length so it is easy to review.

```
$ Write a 1-page Brightwave client onboarding checklist in a Doc: sections for Kickoff, Access, Brand assets, Timeline. Use checkboxes.
```


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LAB 6

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Review the Doc against the brief. Refine one section that is thin, then accept the version you are happy with.

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LAB 6

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Populate a Sheet from unstructured input. Give the agent a few lines of notes and a target column layout.

```
$ Turn these notes into a Sheet with columns Client, Contact, Service, Fee, Status: <paste 4-5 lines of your own notes or the Brightwave sample>.
```


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LAB 6

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Open the Sheet and check every row parsed into the right column. Fix the instruction and re-run if a column is misaligned.

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LAB 6

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Draft a Slides deck from the Doc you made. Keep it short so review is quick.

```
$ Create a 5-slide deck from my onboarding checklist Doc: title slide plus one slide per section, 3 bullets each.
```


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LAB 6

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Review the deck: is each slide on-message and uncluttered? Refine one slide, then keep the improved version.

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LAB 6

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Reflect on the pattern you just used three times — generate, review, refine — and note where it saved you the most time.

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LAB 6

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Save the Doc, Sheet and deck into your Brightwave assistant's Drive folder so later workflows can reuse them.

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LAB 6 · VERIFY

Work with Docs, Sheets and Slides — Generate, Review and Refine

Test it

You have a Doc, a Sheet and a Slides deck the agent generated, each reviewed and refined at least once, with the Sheet's data correctly placed in the right columns.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Automating Work with Gemini Spark Tasks

1. You can now: Use one-off agent tasks to research a topic and to organise emails and Drive files.

2. You can now: Produce a prioritised inbox summary and have the agent draft replies in your voice for approval.

3. You can now: Have the agent create a Doc, populate a Sheet and draft a Slides deck, then review and refine each output.

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03

TOPIC 03

Building Reusable Skills and Schedules

Custom reusable skills · Schedules and triggers · Chaining workflows · Personalising behaviour

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Key Concepts — Building Reusable Skills and Schedules

1. Reusable skills — save a proven instruction as a named skill you can run again and again without re-typing it.
2. The Ghostwriter skill — a worked example: a skill that drafts content in a consistent, personalised style on demand.
3. Schedules — set an agent to run on a cadence, such as a digest every weekday morning, with no manual trigger.
4. Conditional triggers — run a skill only when a condition is met, such as a new email from a specific sender.
5. Chaining — connect skills so the output of one becomes the input of the next, forming a multi-step workflow.
6. Personalisation — teach the agent your preferences, tone and recurring context so its output needs less editing.

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Key Concepts — Building Reusable Skills and Schedules (cont.)

7 Style and voice — capture how you write once, and have every draft match it automatically.

8 Skill hygiene — name, describe and test each skill so you and your team know exactly what it does.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Building Reusable Skills and Schedules

Lab 7

- Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

Lab 8

- Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

Lab 9

- Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

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TOPIC 03 · HANDS-ON

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

LAB 7

A skill is a saved instruction you can run again and again. You build the classic example — a Ghostwriter that drafts content in a consistent style — by capturing your best instruction, naming it, describing it, and testing it on two different inputs so you know it is reliable. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A saved, named 'Brightwave Ghostwriter' skill, tested on two different inputs.

Tools: Reusable skills, saving instructions, naming and describing, style capture, testing

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LAB 7

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Start from a strong instruction. Write one that drafts a short piece of content in your studio's voice.

```
$ Draft a 120-word LinkedIn post about <TOPIC> in Brightwave's voice: friendly, concrete, no hype, one clear call to action.
```


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LAB 7

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Run it once and refine until the style is right — this becomes the body of your skill.

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LAB 7

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Save it as a reusable skill. Give it a clear name and a one-line description of what it does and when to use it.

```
$ Name: Brightwave Ghostwriter | Description: Drafts a short social post in Brightwave's voice from a topic.
```


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LAB 7

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Make the input a placeholder so the skill is reusable: the topic should be something you supply each time you run it.

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LAB 7

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Test the skill on a first topic. Check the draft matches the voice and the word count.

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LAB 7

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Run the SAME skill on a second, different topic. Confirm it stays in voice without you re-typing the instruction.

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LAB 7

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Add one guardrail to the skill's instruction: never invent statistics or client names; leave a placeholder instead.

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LAB 7

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Note two other repeatable tasks in your week that would make good skills — you will need candidates for chaining in Lab 9.

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LAB 7 · VERIFY

Create a Custom Reusable Skill — the Ghostwriter

Test it

You can run your saved Ghostwriter skill by name on any topic and get an in-voice draft of the right length, without re-typing the instruction, and it never invents facts.

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TOPIC 03 · HANDS-ON

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

LAB 8

Automation earns its keep when it runs without you. You put your inbox digest on a schedule so it arrives every weekday morning, then add a conditional trigger so a skill fires only when something specific happens — such as an email from a key client. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A scheduled daily inbox digest and one conditional trigger, both tested.

Tools: Schedules, cadence, conditional triggers, event conditions, approvals on automation

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LAB 8

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Take your inbox-summary instruction from Lab 5 and set it to run on a schedule.

```
$ Every weekday at 8:00am, summarise my unread emails as Urgent / Needs a reply / FYI and put the digest in a Doc named 'Daily Digest'.
```


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LAB 8

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Choose the cadence and time deliberately — early enough to be useful, not so early the inbox is empty.

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LAB 8

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Decide the approval posture for scheduled runs: reading and drafting can run unattended; sending or sharing should still need approval. Set it.

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LAB 8

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Test the schedule without waiting a day: use the 'run now' option to fire it once and confirm the digest Doc is created.

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LAB 8

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Now build a conditional trigger. Choose a condition that matters and a safe action (draft, don't send).

```
$ When a new email arrives from <KEY CLIENT EMAIL>, draft a holding reply saying we'll respond within one business day. Save as draft; do not send.
```


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LAB 8

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Test the trigger safely: send yourself a test email that meets the condition (or use the sample), and confirm the draft is created.

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LAB 8

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Check the activity log to see the scheduled run and the triggered run recorded as separate entries.

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LAB 8

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Set a stop rule: note how you would pause or delete a schedule or trigger if it ever misbehaves.

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LAB 8 · VERIFY

Design Schedules and Conditional Triggers

Test it

Your inbox digest runs on its schedule (verified with 'run now') and your conditional trigger creates a draft only when the condition is met — both visible as entries in the activity log.

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TOPIC 03 · HANDS-ON

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

LAB 9

Real automation is more than one step. You chain skills so the output of one becomes the input of the next — turning several manual actions into one run — and you personalise the agent with your recurring context and preferences so every result starts closer to done. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A two-or-three-step chained workflow and a saved personalisation profile for your agent.

Tools: Chaining, multi-step workflows, passing outputs as inputs, personalisation, preferences, style profile

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LAB 9

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Sketch a short chain on paper first: step 1 produces something step 2 uses. Keep it to two or three steps.

```
$ CHAIN: 1) summarise this week's client emails -> 2) draft a weekly update from that summary -> 3) create a Doc for review.
```


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LAB 9

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Build step 1 as an instruction (or reuse a skill) that produces a clear, structured output for the next step to consume.

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LAB 9

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Build step 2 so it explicitly takes step 1's output as its input, rather than starting from scratch.

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LAB 9

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Add step 3 to place the final result where you want it (a Doc in your Brightwave folder), as a draft for review.

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LAB 9

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Run the whole chain once and review each hand-off: did step 2 actually use step 1's output? Refine the weak link.

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LAB 9

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Now personalise the agent. Save a profile of recurring context so you stop repeating yourself.

```
$ Remember: I'm the ops coordinator at Brightwave Studio. Our clients are SMEs. Default tone: warm and brief. Working hours 9-6, Mon-Fri.
```


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LAB 9

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Re-run one earlier task and confirm the personalisation improved it — less context to type, output closer to your style.

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LAB 9

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Save the chained workflow so you can run the whole thing next week with one instruction.

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LAB 9 · VERIFY

Chain Multi-Step Workflows and Personalise Your Agent

Test it

Running your chained workflow once produces the final Doc with each step visibly using the previous step's output, and your saved personalisation profile measurably reduces how much you have to edit or re-explain.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Building Reusable Skills and Schedules

1. You can now: Turn a proven instruction into a named, reusable skill and run it repeatedly with different inputs.

2. You can now: Schedule a skill to run automatically on a cadence and add a trigger that runs only when a condition is met.

3. You can now: Connect skills so one feeds the next into a single workflow, and personalise the agent so output needs less editing.

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04

TOPIC 04

Advanced Agentic Workflows and Real-World Automation

Lead, expense and planning automation · Multi-app coordination · Guardrails · Monitoring and scaling

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Key Concepts — Advanced Agentic Workflows and Real-World Automation

1. Real-world automation — assemble skills and schedules into workflows that handle everyday business tasks end to end.
2. Lead management — capture an enquiry, log it to a sheet and draft a timely follow-up, all through the agent.
3. Expense and planning — turn receipts and notes into a tidy record, and a rough plan into a scheduled agenda.
4. Multi-app coordination — a single workflow that spans Gmail, Calendar, Drive and Sheets in one connected run.
5. Guardrails — set explicit limits on what an agent may do, so automation is safe by design, not by luck.
6. Permissions and privacy — grant least access, keep confidential data out of prompts, and know where data flows.

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Key Concepts — Advanced Agentic Workflows and Real-World Automation (cont.)

7 Monitoring — read the activity log to catch mistakes early and confirm your agents are doing the right thing.

8 Improving and scaling — refine instructions, add guardrails and roll trusted agents out to more of your work or team.

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WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Advanced Agentic Workflows and Real-World Automation

Lab 10

- Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

Lab 11

- Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

Lab 12

- Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

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TOPIC 04 · HANDS-ON

Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

LAB 10

This is the payoff: automations that handle whole tasks. You build a lead-intake flow that logs an enquiry and drafts a follow-up, an expense flow that turns receipts and notes into a clean record, and a planning flow that turns rough notes into a scheduled agenda. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

Three real-world automations: lead intake, expense logging and a planning agenda — each tested once.

Tools: Lead management, Sheets logging, follow-up drafting, expense extraction, planning, Calendar

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LAB 10

Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Build the lead-intake flow. From an enquiry email, log the lead to a Sheet and draft a follow-up for approval.

```
$ From new emails labelled 'Lead', add a row to 'Leads' Sheet (Name, Company, Ask, Date) and draft a follow-up reply. Save drafts; do not send.
```


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Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Test it with one sample enquiry. Confirm the row appears with the right fields and a sensible follow-up draft is created.

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LAB 10

Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Build the expense flow. Turn a set of expense notes (or receipt details you type) into a clean, categorised record.

```
$ Turn these expense notes into an 'Expenses' Sheet with Date, Vendor, Category, Amount, and a running total: <paste your notes or the sample>.
```


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Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Review the expense Sheet: are categories sensible and the total correct? Refine the categories in the instruction and re-run if needed.

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LAB 10

Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Build the planning flow. Turn rough notes about a piece of work into a sequenced plan with dates.

```
$ Turn these notes into a step-by-step plan with suggested dates this month, then draft calendar events for each step. Do not create events yet.
```


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LAB 10

Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Review the proposed plan and events. Approve creating events only for the steps you agree with, then check Calendar.

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Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Look across the three flows and note where they share data (a lead could become a planned piece of work) — a hint for Lab 11.

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Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Save all three as skills so they are ready to run again and to combine next.

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LAB 10 · VERIFY

Automate Lead Management, Expenses and Planning

Test it

You have a lead logged to a Sheet with an approved follow-up draft, an accurate categorised expense record with a correct total, and a plan whose approved steps appear as Calendar events.

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TOPIC 04 · HANDS-ON

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

LAB 11

Now the apps work together. You build a single workflow that touches Gmail, Sheets, Calendar and Drive in one run, then do the essential engineering work of safe automation: set least-privilege permissions, keep confidential data out of prompts, and write explicit guardrails. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

One multi-app workflow plus a written guardrails checklist applied to your agents.

Tools: Multi-app coordination, Gmail, Sheets, Calendar, Drive, least privilege, privacy, guardrails

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LAB 11

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Design a workflow that deliberately spans apps. Reuse skills from Lab 10 so this is coordination, not new work.

```
$ When a 'Lead' email arrives: 1) log it to the Leads Sheet, 2) draft a follow-up, 3) add a 'Review lead' event tomorrow, 4) file the email to Drive/Leads.
```


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LAB 11

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Run it once on a sample lead and check each app in turn: Sheet row, Gmail draft, Calendar event, Drive file. Fix the step that failed.

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LAB 11

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

STEP 3 OF 8

3

Review permissions with least privilege in mind: does any agent have access it does not need? Remove access that is not required.

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LAB 11

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Set a privacy guardrail: instruct your agents never to include confidential data in outputs and to use placeholders for anything sensitive.

```
$ Never put client financials, personal ID numbers or passwords into any draft, Sheet or Doc. Use <REDACTED> instead and flag it to me.
```


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LAB 11

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Set an action guardrail: nothing is sent, shared externally or deleted without explicit approval, even on scheduled runs.

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LAB 11

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Test a guardrail on purpose: ask the agent to do something the guardrail forbids and confirm it refuses or asks first.

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LAB 11

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Write a short guardrails checklist (permissions, privacy, actions, approvals) and apply it to every skill you keep.

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LAB 11

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Confirm in the activity log that the multi-app run is recorded as one connected workflow you can review end to end.

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LAB 11 · VERIFY

Coordinate Multi-App Workflows and Set Safe-Automation Guardrails

Test it

Your multi-app workflow completes across Gmail, Sheets, Calendar and Drive from a single trigger, your agent refuses a forbidden action when tested, and you have a written guardrails checklist applied to your kept skills.

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TOPIC 04 · HANDS-ON

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

LAB 12

You finish by turning a set of automations into a dependable assistant. You review everything you built from the activity log, fix the instructions that produced weak results, and write a simple plan to scale your agents to more of your work — or your team — without losing control. BUILDING BLOCK — the automation you build in this lab is added to your AI operations assistant, the connected toolkit you assemble across all 12 labs.

You'll build

A monitored, improved AI operations assistant and a one-page plan to scale it responsibly.

Tools: Monitoring, activity log review, instruction improvement, reliability, scaling, governance

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LAB 12

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

STEP 1 OF 8

1

Inventory your assistant: list every task, skill, schedule and workflow you built across the 12 labs.

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LAB 12

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

STEP 2 OF 8

2

Monitor from the activity log: review recent runs and mark any that produced a wrong, incomplete or off-tone result.

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LAB 12

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

STEP 3 OF 8

3

For each weak result, find the root cause in the instruction — usually a missing Input, Output or Limit — and fix it.

```
$ Improve one skill: add the missing part (e.g. 'Output: a Doc named X' or 'Limit: never send') and re-run to confirm it is fixed.
```


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LAB 12

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

STEP 4 OF 8

4

Add a reliability check to your most-used skill: a line that makes the agent state what it did so you can verify at a glance.

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LAB 12

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

STEP 5 OF 8

5

Decide what is safe to run unattended and what must always pause for approval, and set each accordingly.

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LAB 12

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

STEP 6 OF 8

6

Write your scaling plan: which two automations to expand next, who else could use them, and the guardrails that must travel with them.

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LAB 12

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

STEP 7 OF 8

7

Pick one skill to hand over: document its name, purpose, inputs, output and guardrails so a colleague could run it safely.

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LAB 12

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

STEP 8 OF 8

8

Write your 30-day automation roadmap: one new automation a week, each with a 'Test it' check, starting with the highest time saver.

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LAB 12 · VERIFY

Monitor, Improve and Scale Your AI Agents

Test it

You have a written inventory of everything you built, at least one instruction improved after monitoring its log, a documented hand-over for one skill, and a one-page 30-day plan to scale your agents with guardrails.

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TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Advanced Agentic Workflows and Real-World Automation

1. You can now: Build agent workflows that capture leads, log expenses and turn notes into a plan — end to end.

2. You can now: Run one workflow that spans several Workspace apps, and set permission, privacy and safety guardrails.

3. You can now: Consolidate your assistant, monitor it from the activity log, improve weak instructions and plan to scale safely.

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WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

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LEARNING OUTCOMES

What You Achieved

1

Understand agents

Explain what autonomous AI agents are and how Gemini Spark's background agents, approvals and controls work.

2

Connect & instruct

Connect Gemini Spark to Google Workspace and write clear, effective instructions that an agent can act on.

3

Automate with tasks

Create one-off agent tasks to research, organise, summarise email and draft content across Docs, Sheets and Slides.

4

Review & approve

Review, approve and refine agent actions so automated work stays accurate and under your control.

5

Skills & schedules

Build custom reusable skills and design schedules and conditional triggers that run automatically.

6

Chain & personalise

Chain multi-step workflows across several Workspace apps and personalise your agent's behaviour and style.

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LEARNING OUTCOMES

What You Achieved (cont.)

7

Real-world automation

Automate real-world workflows — lead management, expenses and planning — with sound permission and privacy guardrails.

8

Monitor & scale

Monitor, improve and scale your AI agents responsibly.

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Keep Practising After the Course

1. Re-run the labs on your own machine — repetition is what makes the skills stick.
2. Apply the techniques to a real process or project in your own organisation.
3. Your course material stays available at https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/.
4. Explore the follow-on courses at www.tertiarycourses.com.sg.

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THANK YOU FOR ATTENDING

Thank You!

You now have the practical skills from every lab in this course — keep applying them to your own work.

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